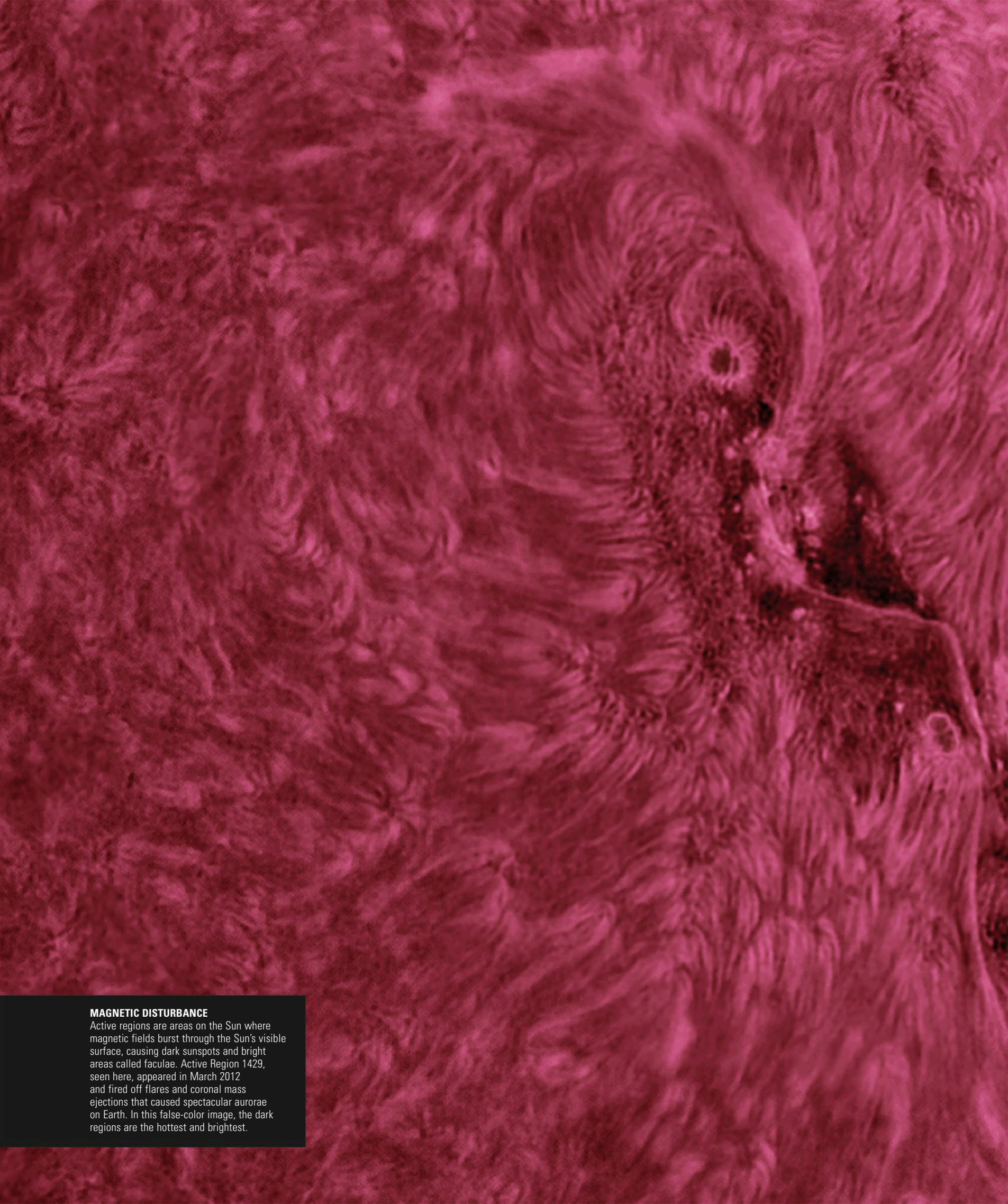




MAGNETIC DISTURBANCE

Active regions are areas on the Sun where magnetic fields burst through the Sun's visible surface, causing dark sunspots and bright areas called faculae. Active Region 1429, seen here, appeared in March 2012 and fired off flares and coronal mass ejections that caused spectacular aurorae on Earth. In this false-color image, the dark regions are the hottest and brightest.